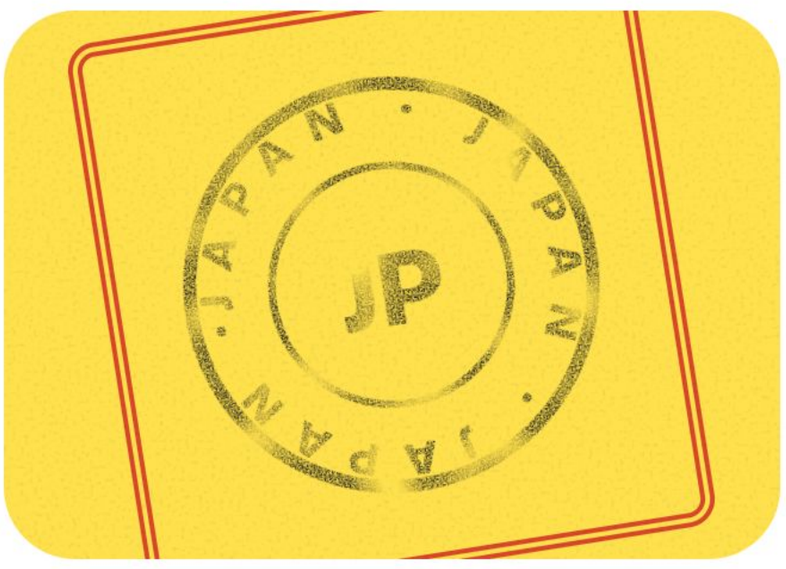
Japan picks one kanji to sum up the year





Aidan McFarlane

aidanmdesign.xyz

The 2025 vote



12 Dec

Announced on this date each year

熊

The 2025 kanji, meaning bear

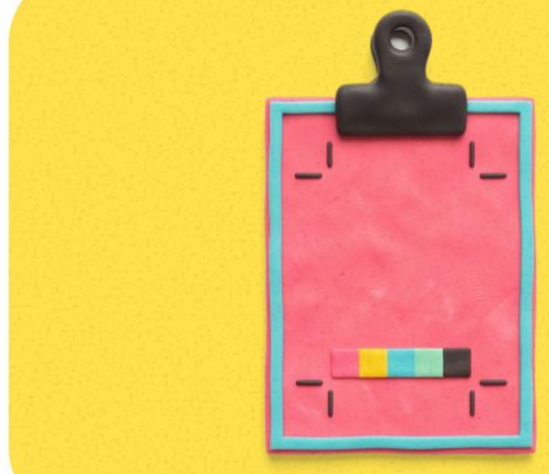
12.34%

Share of the 189,122 votes

Source: 日本漢字能力検定協会

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How it works



Vote

A public vote run by the Kanji Aptitude Test Foundation

Brush

Written live at Kiyomizu-dera in Kyoto

Close

2025: 熊 beat 米 by 180 votes

Source: 日本漢字能力検定協会

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One character, one message

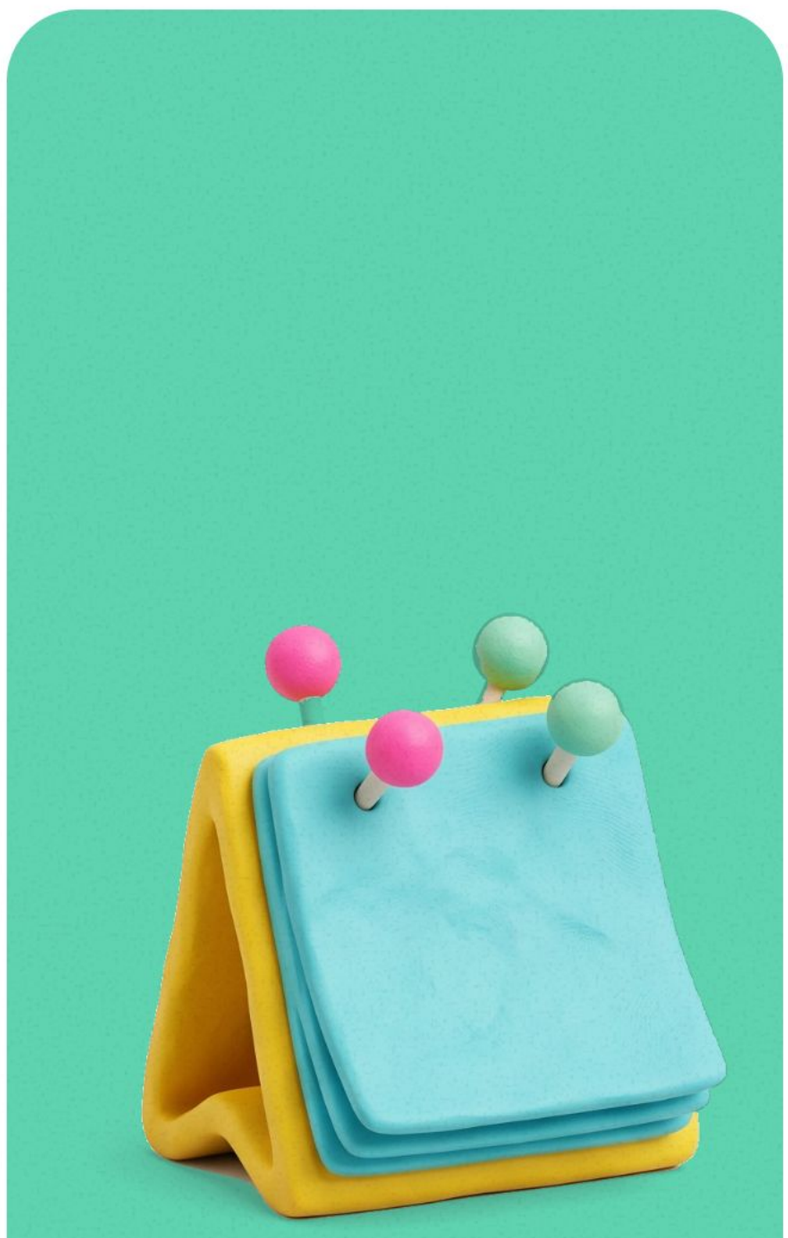
Japanese readers are used to a single kanji carrying a theme.

A one-word campaign theme fits that habit.

熊

II

a year, in one word



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In Japan, a year can be one character.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

Aidan McFarlane
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